



Good Faith Estimate and Financial Policy

Purpose and scope

Skinner Legacies gives uninsured and qualifying self pay individuals a written, individualized Good Faith Estimate (GFE) of expected charges before scheduled care or upon request. This policy governs intake, estimates, fee discussions, revisions, records, and billing. It does not authorize billing an Ohio Medicaid member for covered services contrary to Medicaid requirements.

Responsibilities

The intake or scheduling staff member asks about coverage and intended use of insurance, tells eligible people about the GFE, logs a request or scheduling event, and routes it to billing. Billing prepares the itemized estimate using the approved current fee schedule and any approved discount, verifies expected quantity and codes with clinical staff, sends it on time, and retains delivery evidence. The clinical lead identifies reasonably expected services and material changes. The compliance officer reviews disputes, exceptions, and periodic samples.

Eligibility and notice

At scheduling, ask whether the person has coverage, including a federal health program, and whether a person with commercial coverage wants a claim submitted. Apply the federal GFE rule to a person without benefits for the service or with commercial coverage who elects not to submit a claim. Do not assume a federal-program enrollee is a qualifying self pay individual. Treat any inquiry about possible cost as a GFE request.

Post the plain language right-to-a-GFE notice prominently in the lobby and scheduling areas and on the public website where it is easily searchable; give it orally during scheduling or cost discussions. Offer accessible formats and languages used by people seeking services. A cost conversation does not replace the written estimate.

Issue deadlines

Trigger	Deadline for written estimate
Scheduled 3–9 business days ahead	Within 1 business day after scheduling
Scheduled 10 or more business days ahead	Within 3 business days after scheduling
Requested estimate, whether scheduled or not	Within 3 business days of request
Material change to a scheduled estimate	New estimate no later than 1 business day before service

For an appointment scheduled less than 3 business days ahead, issue a GFE if requested under the request deadline; staff should still discuss known prices promptly. Once a requested service is scheduled, issue a new scheduled estimate under the applicable scheduling deadline. Business days exclude weekends and federal holidays.

Preparing and delivering the estimate

Use the individualized form. Include name, birth date, primary service and date or period, itemized reasonably expected services grouped by provider, diagnosis and service codes when applicable, expected charges after any approved discount, each represented provider's name, NPI, tax ID and location, and the required disclaimers and



dispute instructions. A recurring estimate must state time span, frequency and number of visits and cover no more than 12 months. Never describe a proposed discount as approved until confirmed.

Request estimate information from any reasonably expected co-provider within 1 business day of request or scheduling and document the outreach. Apply current federal enforcement guidance to any incomplete co-provider information; do not omit Skinner Legacies' own expected charges. Deliver a clear written or electronic copy according to the person's preference and record the method and timestamp.

Financial terms and changes

Review the approved fee schedule, expected session type and frequency with the person. A fee reduction or payment arrangement requires documented approval under the separate financial-assistance criteria; use the actual expected self pay rate in the estimate. Explain when payment is due using the signed financial agreement. Do not treat a GFE as consent to treatment or as a promise of a fixed final charge. Reissue when anticipated services, providers, frequency, duration, or charges materially change. Explain differences before service when feasible.

Records, complaints, and review

Retain the eligibility inquiry, request and scheduling date, approved rate and discount basis, each issued version, co-provider outreach, delivery proof, and relevant bills in the client's restricted billing record under the agency retention schedule and applicable law. Direct disputed bills immediately to billing and the compliance officer; preserve the original estimate and billing history. Explain the federal dispute option without discouraging its use; cooperate with the process and any correction. Review a sample of estimates at least annually and after a substantiated complaint.

Authority: 45 CFR 149.610 and 149.620; CMS uninsured and self pay GFE guidance; applicable Ohio Medicaid billing rules.